VOL. I WEEKDAY EDITION

# THE TESLA DISPATCH

*Weekday briefing on Tesla's cars, autonomy, robots, energy and stock*

THURSDAY, OCTOBER 22, 2026 MARKET DATA AS OF WED OCT 21 CLOSE

THE MORNING PICTURE

## A beat, a cash surprise and a $20 billion budget

Tesla earned an adjusted 48 cents a share in the third quarter on revenue of $28.05 billion, ahead of the 43 cents and $27.9 billion analysts polled by LSEG expected, CNBC reported. GAAP net income fell 43% to $787 million, or 22 cents a share, while free cash flow was a positive $1.53 billion, according to Tesla's shareholder update, filed with the SEC at 4:41 p.m. EDT Wednesday.

"After many years of grind and things being fairly flat, I think we are now headed for a lot of fun and significant growth," Elon Musk said on the webcast (transcript). The shares, which rose 3.41% to $386.47 in Wednesday's session, slid more than 3% in extended trading, CNBC reported, and were down about 4% in premarket trading on Thursday, according to CNBC.

I · FULL SELF-DRIVING (FSD)

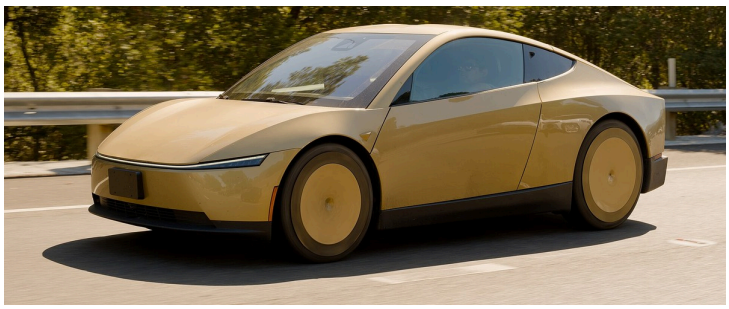
## FSD on three of four new cars

*Over 75% of North American deliveries came with paid FSD, and Robotaxi published its first safety report.*

More than 75% of vehicles delivered in North America in the quarter included a paid FSD (Supervised) sign-up, "approximately 20% higher than Q2," Chief Financial Officer Vaibhav Taneja said, and active subscriptions rose 67% from a year earlier to 1.74 million, Tesla's shareholder update shows. He said FSD now has "over 1.7 million paid customers globally, of which for the first time, 50% is based on subscriptions" (transcript).

### A safety report for Robotaxi

"Till date, Robotaxi has driven a total of 3.3 million miles autonomously, and has had zero injuries nor airbag deployments," AI software head Ashok Elluswamy posted at 2:58 p.m. EDT Wednesday as Tesla launched a Robotaxi safety report. "If the same number of miles were to be manually driven, we should expect roughly 9 injuries to the occupants or other pedestrians and 4 airbag deployments on average."



A Tesla Cybercab on Interstate 280 in California on September 19, 2026.
PHOTO: DANIEL LU (DLLU) / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY-SA 4.0 · CROPPED

On the call, Elluswamy said the same software runs on Cybercab and Model Y and will reach customers "as part of the V15 release," and that "somewhere around Q2 next year" the first customer-owned Model Ys could join the Robotaxi fleet. "Over the rest of this year, we'll unlock 24/7 operation, go to higher speed roads," he said; Cybercab launches in Dallas next month (transcript). Texas's Department of Motor Vehicles lists 362 Model Y Robotaxis and 449 Cybercabs authorized for driverless operation, CNBC reported.

### Europe and software

FSD (Supervised) is now approved in nine European countries, four of them added since the second quarter, including Slovakia, with more than 100,000 users, Tesla's update says. Musk said he would "be surprised if it takes longer than Q1" to win EU-wide approval (transcript). The Netherlands approved it in April, followed by Lithuania on May 20, Estonia on May 29, Denmark on June 9, Belgium on June 10, Slovenia on Sept. 7, the Czech Republic on Sept. 21 and Croatia on Sept. 29, EV reported before Slovakia's recognition. Update 2026.38.5.10, with FSD v14.3 Lite for HW3 cars and v14.3.13 for HW4, was on 0.3% of cars tracked by TeslaFi, Not a Tesla App shows.

II · SALES & DEMAND

# "Highest backlog in four years"

*Deliveries were limited mainly by production, Taneja said, as auto margins widened.*

Tesla delivered 486,532 vehicles and built 464,391 in the quarter, its second straight quarter above 480,000 deliveries, and "exited the quarter with our highest backlog in four years, with deliveries constrained primarily by production," Taneja said. Automotive gross margin excluding regulatory credits rose to 18.1% from 16.3% in the second quarter on a higher mix of deliveries in Asia-Pacific (transcript).

Automotive revenue fell 3% from a year earlier to $20.56 billion, while services and other revenue rose 33% to $4.61 billion, with record services gross profit of $734 million; Tesla built its 10 millionth vehicle and Gigafactory Berlin had record production, the shareholder update shows. Musk said Tesla aims for "5 million vehicles a year by approximately 2030," and vehicle engineering chief Lars Moravy said Tesla has applied for permits to expand the Berlin factory (transcript).

QUICK HIT

**"People are buying FSD with a car attached, not the other way around,"** Musk wrote at 4:54 p.m. EDT Wednesday, quoting a summary of the results.

III · ENERGY & CHARGING

# Energy margin jumps to 33.1%

*Tariff refunds and warranty true-downs lifted the storage business; Megapacks are "almost sold out" for 2027.*

Tesla deployed 13.7 gigawatt-hours (GWh) of storage, its second-best quarter, and energy gross margin rose to 33.1% from 20.4%, mainly because of "tariff refunds recognized in the quarter and warranty true-downs," Taneja said (transcript). Energy revenue fell 16% from a year earlier to $2.88 billion. Megafactory Texas began production and Tesla delivered its first Megapacks with in-house LFP cells, according to the shareholder update; Musk said the company is "almost sold out of all Megapacks for 2027" (transcript).

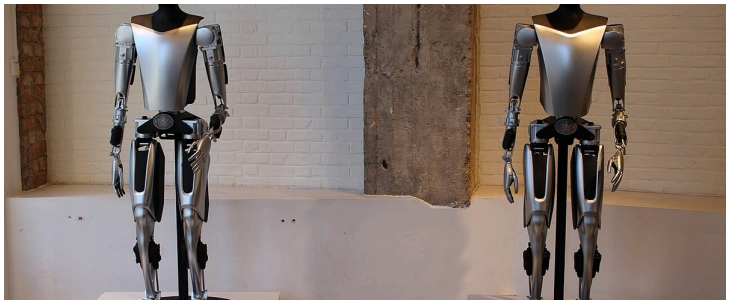
Tesla added more than 2,100 net Supercharger stalls in the quarter, up 14%, to 8,904 stations and 84,465 connectors, the update shows. Since Wednesday morning, Tesla Charging has announced new sites in Potenza, Italy, with 8 stalls (post, 12:47 p.m. EDT); Deerfield Beach, Florida, on West Hillsboro Boulevard, with 24 (post); Valley View, Texas, a Supercharger for Business site with 8 (post); Waynesburg, Pennsylvania, with 12 (post); Kingston, Ontario, on Highway 15, with 12 (post); and Novato, California, with 8 (post, 11:50 p.m. EDT).

More than 600 sites now take part in Supercharger for Business, and Tesla opened its first Accordion Supercharger and its first Megacharger for the Semi during the quarter, the update says.

IV · OPTIMUS, TERAFAB & SPENDING

# "At least a year" to 20,000 robots a week

*Tesla lined up $30 billion of credit as spending on AI, chips and factories climbs.*



Two Tesla Optimus humanoid robots on display in Stockholm on May 13, 2024.

PHOTO: ULF KLINGSTRÖM / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · PUBLIC DOMAIN

Optimus is in "early production" on a high-volume line in Fremont, Musk said, but reaching an annualized rate of 20,000 units a week will take "probably at least a year, maybe a little longer," with deliveries to outside companies expected around the end of next year. Terafab, the chip venture with SpaceX, aims for a first test chip around May or June and volume "around Q3 of 2028"; its cost is "certainly in the tens of billions," he said (transcript).

Tesla now expects 2026 capital spending "in excess of $20 billion," and in September entered into three credit agreements with aggregate commitments of $30 billion, its 10-Q says; nine-month capital spending was $13.01 billion. Operating expenses rose 39% to $4.78 billion, and net income included a $142 million mark-to-market loss on its SpaceX holding, offset by a roughly $290 million gain on Bitcoin, Taneja said (transcript). Cash and investments ended at $45.45 billion.

The Semi entered volume production in Nevada, with 500 miles of range at 82,000 pounds, the update says.



A Tesla Semi in Rocklin, California, on March 8, 2018.
PHOTO: KORBITR / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · PUBLIC DOMAIN · CROPPED

### Cybercab for customers

"We are trying to get Cybercabs to customers by the end of this year, 2026," Moravy said; for now every Cybercab built at Giga Texas goes to Tesla's own Robotaxi fleet. Musk said Cybercab "is primarily going to be something that is offered as transport as a service," and that Robotaxi revenue is "not going to move the needle this quarter" but "starts to become noticeable probably in Q2 and then probably a big deal by Q3 or Q4 of next year" (transcript).

### Compute

Tesla is targeting 400 megawatts of AI training compute by year-end, with its Cortex 1 cluster above 105 MW and Cortex 2 above 120 MW, and the Austin research fab for chips is to be commissioned in 2027, the shareholder update says. Musk said the AI5 chip, with "an order of magnitude more compute" than AI4, should go into Optimus around April (transcript).

QUICK HIT

**Lars Moravy** @larsmoravy replied at 6:34 p.m. EDT to doubts about the new Roadster's thrusters: "we don't show things that we can't do in production. The cold gas system can produce over 80kN of force."

V · SEC FILINGS

## Results 8-K and the third-quarter 10-Q

**8-K · Oct 21, 4:41 p.m. EDT** — Items 2.02 and 9.01: third-quarter results, with the shareholder update as Exhibit 99.1. Filing

**10-Q · Oct 21, 8:12 p.m. EDT** — Quarterly report for the period ended Sep 30; 3,952,757,946 shares outstanding as of Oct 15. Filing

**Insider trades, last 120 days (Form 4)** — Sep 8: Chief Financial Officer Vaibhav Taneja sold 2,605.75 shares at $360.13 after 6,539 restricted stock units vested on Sep 5; 25,972.25 shares afterward (filed Sep 9).

### Takeaways

1. Adjusted EPS of 48 cents beat the 43-cent estimate; revenue was $28.05 billion.
2. Free cash flow was $1.53 billion; capital spending is set to top $20 billion.
3. Over 75% of North American deliveries came with paid FSD.
4. Robotaxi reports 3.3 million autonomous miles with zero injuries.
5. TSLA rose 3.41% Wednesday, then fell in extended trading.

SOURCES

Posts by @aelluswamy, @elonmusk, @larsmoravy and @TeslaCharging on X; SEC EDGAR; Tesla shareholder update and 10-Q; Stock Analysis (Quartr transcript); CNBC; EV (eletric-vehicles.com); Not a Tesla App; Yahoo Finance via yfinance; CBOE. Photos: Wikimedia Commons (Daniel Lu, CC BY-SA 4.0; Korbitr, public domain; Ulf Klingström, public domain).

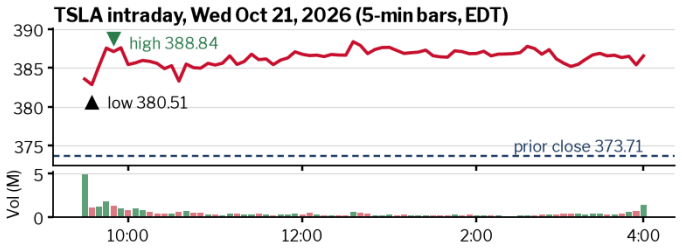
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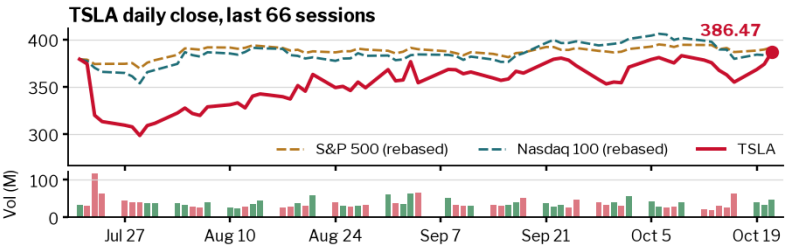
# Up 3.4% into the report

*After the report, Canaccord raised its target to $442 from $410 and Goldman Sachs kept Neutral at $360, CNBC reported.*

| CLOSE | CHANGE | OPEN | DAY HIGH | DAY LOW |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| $386.47 | +$12.76 | $381.43 | $388.84 | $380.51 |
| Wed Oct 21, 4:00 p.m. EDT | +3.41% vs $373.71 | regular session | 9:50 a.m. EDT bar | 9:35 a.m. EDT bar |
| **VOLUME** | **52-WEEK RANGE** | **MARKET CAP** | **5-DAY / 1-MONTH** | **YEAR TO DATE** |
| 47.65M | $297–$499 | $1.53T | +5.3% / +2.0% | −14.06% |
| +37.6% vs 30-session avg 34.62M | $297.38 (Jul 29, 2026) to $498.83 (Dec 22, 2025) | 3.95B shares (10-Q cover, Oct 15) × close | 5 and 21 sessions | vs Dec 31, 2025 close |

**52-WEEK RANGE** — low $297.38 · Jul 29 | close $386.47 | high $498.83 · Dec 22, 2025 | 50-day avg $362.18




As of close Oct 21, 2026; times EDT. Source: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (regular session, unadjusted). Dashed navy = prior close; triangles = session high/low; volume green/red = up/down vs prior bar; index lines rebased to the first close shown.

## RELATIVE PERFORMANCE, AS OF OCT 21 CLOSE

| TICKER | 1-DAY | 5-DAY | 1-MONTH | YTD |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **TSLA** | **+3.41%** | **+5.26%** | **+2.00%** | **−14.06%** |
| S&P 500 | +0.58% | +0.50% | −0.10% | +13.32% |
| Nasdaq 100 | +1.13% | −0.43% | −2.96% | +18.11% |
| RIVN | +0.24% | −3.78% | −17.70% | −36.78% |
| GM | −1.27% | −8.36% | −8.80% | −6.41% |
| F | −2.06% | −1.24% | −9.16% | −9.30% |

## OPTIONS (CBOE, WED OCT 21 CLOSE)

| EXPIRY | CALL OI | PUT OI | P/C | ATM IV | TOP CALL / PUT |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Oct 23 | 273,316 | 270,004 | 0.99 | 93.6% | $400 / $130 |
| Oct 26 | 49,987 | 29,575 | 0.59 | 63.0% | $455 / $310 |
| Oct 28 | 9,384 | 10,690 | 1.14 | 57.9% | $420 / $350 |
| **All expiries** | **3,083,274** | **2,435,117** | **0.79** | | **30-day IV index 42.9** |

## ANALYST CONSENSUS · OCT 22

| | |
|---|---|
| Strong buy | 4 |
| Buy | 15 |
| Hold | 22 |
| Sell | 2 |
| Strong sell | 1 |
| Mean rating (1 = strong buy) | 2.36 |
| Mean target (37 analysts) | $401.40 (+3.9%) |
| Median target | $420.00 |
| High / low target | $600.00 / $128.11 |

## SHORT INTEREST & OWNERSHIP

| | |
|---|---|
| Short interest, Sep 30 | 70.93M |
| Change vs. mid-September | −4.4% |
| Short % of float | 2.01% |
| Days to cover | 1.79 |
| Held by insiders | 17.81% |
| Held by institutions | 43.67% |
| BlackRock, Jun 30 | 5.42% |
| Vanguard, Jun 30 | 4.66% |

## VALUATION & TREND · OCT 21 CLOSE

| | |
|---|---|
| Trailing P/E (EPS $0.91) | 424.7 |
| Forward P/E (est. $2.18) | 177.6 |
| Price/sales (rev. $103.6B) | 14.7 |
| Beta (5-year monthly) | 1.92 |
| 50-day average | $362.18 (+6.7%) |
| 200-day average | $386.94 (−0.1%) |
| Q3 adj. EPS vs LSEG est. | $0.48 vs $0.43 |
| Q3 revenue vs LSEG est. | $28.05B vs $27.9B |

## RECENT RATING ACTIONS

| DATE | FIRM | RATING | TARGET |
|---|---|---|---|
| Oct 22 | Mizuho | Outperform | $450 to $460 |
| Oct 22 | Cantor Fitzgerald | Overweight | $485 |
| Oct 22 | Needham | Hold | — |
| Oct 15 | GLJ Research | Sell | $24.86 |
| Oct 12 | Jefferies | Hold | $350 to $400 |
| Oct 8 | Tigress Financial | Buy | $550 |
| Oct 7 | UBS | Neutral | $385 to $391 |

## CATALYST CALENDAR

| DATE | EVENT |
|---|---|
| Fri Oct 23 | Weekly options expiry (largest near-term OI) |
| Fri Oct 30 | Cybercab answers due to NHTSA |
| Sat Nov 7 | In-person meeting drawing closes, 12:59 a.m. EST |
| Wed Dec 2 | Proxy voting deadline, 11:59 p.m. EST |
| **Thu Dec 3** | **Annual meeting, 4:00 p.m. EST** |

*Prices and averages: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (unadjusted; 30-session average excludes Oct 21). Consensus, targets, ratings, short interest, ownership and forward EPS: Yahoo Finance, retrieved Thu Oct 22, 8:42 a.m. EDT. Trailing P/E (price to earnings per share, EPS) uses GAAP EPS for the last four quarters ($0.24, $0.13, $0.32, $0.22) from Tesla's shareholder update; price/sales uses trailing revenue at the Oct 21 close. Estimates: LSEG via CNBC. Shares: Tesla 10-Q cover page, Oct 15. Options: CBOE delayed quotes; open interest (OI) is contracts outstanding after Tuesday's close, P/C is the put/call ratio by OI, ATM IV is implied volatility at the $387.50 strike at Wednesday's close. Calendar: DEF 14A, VoteTesla.com, Yahoo Finance.*